A-A-50813A
February 14, 1983

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

BALL, ABSORBENT, Cotton or Rayon

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to JJJ-B-91E.

This commerical item description covers two different sizes of absorbent balls, suitable for use as an absorbent medical wipe or sponge.

Salient characteristics:

The absorbent ball shall be non-sterile, fabricated uniformly of either cotton or rayon fibers and shall be either spherical or barrel shaped. The finished ball shall be constructed to preclude separation of fibers during use in either the dry or saturated condition. Balls of a specified size shall be uniform.

Weight and diameter. The average weight and diameter of size 1 and size 2 absorbent balls shall be as follows:

	Grains per ball		Diameter	Minimum
	Minimum	Maximum	(Inches)	Diameter (Inches)
Size 1	3-1/2	5-1/2	1-1/4	1
Size 2	12-1/2	17-1/2	2	1-1/2

Materials. The basic material shall be either cotton or rayon fibers, bleached and undyed.

Cotton shall meet the requirements of Purified Cotton, USP, except for absorbency, fiber length and sterility. Cotton shall retain not less than 20 times its weight of water and shall submerge in 10 seconds or less.

Rayon shall meet the requirements of Purified Rayon, USP, except for residue, fiber length, absorbency and acid-insoluble ash.

Workmanship. The absorbent balls shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package, containing four thousand balls of size 1 or two thousand balls of size 2, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices and is the same product sold in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U. S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance

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by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

6510-00-201-4100 - Size 1
6510-00-201-4150 - Size 2

Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:

VA-OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

AGENT:

DLA-DM

Project No. 6510-0687

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